
Veritas Lab

Brand Style Guide

Team: **DeltaTech**

Client: **Naked Insurance**

Year: **2026**

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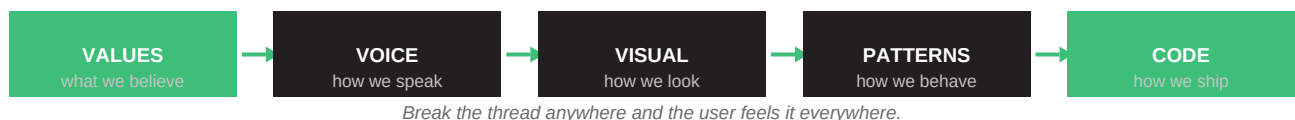
1. Introduction and The Golden Thread

This Brand Style Guide defines the visual identity of **Veritas Lab**, a Deepfake, Misinformation and Media Provenance Workbench built by team **DeltaTech** for **Naked Insurance** as part of the COS 301 Software Engineering Capstone at the University of Pretoria (2026).

It is the single source of truth for all interface-related decisions. Every developer and designer on the team is required to follow these guidelines when implementing any part of the system, ensuring a consistent, professional, and accessible experience across all screens.

1.1 The Golden Thread

A great product feels like one author wrote every word, drew every pixel, and shipped every line of code. That illusion is engineered. The mechanism behind it is the **golden thread**: a continuous chain of decisions running from values, through identity, through design, into code.



This guide represents the **VISUAL** and **PATTERNS** layers of that chain. It cannot be read in isolation: it flows from the Brand Foundation (Section 2) and feeds into the component code our team writes. Break the thread anywhere, a developer who ignores the spacing token, a screen that invents a fifth button colour, and the user feels the inconsistency everywhere.

1.2 Scope

- All screens of the Veritas Lab web application (Next.js + React frontend).
- All components built on or extending the team's custom component library.
- Any documentation, exported reports, or presentation materials produced by the system.
- Glassmorphic or alternative themes must still honour the colour tokens and type scale defined here.
- This guide covers the **Brand Style Guide** layer. The companion Design System (tokens in code, Storybook component docs, API contracts) is a living document in the repository.

2. Brand Foundation

Before any pixel is placed, the brand must have a foundation. These four elements are defined before any colour is chosen or any component is drawn. They are the source from which every visual decision flows.

PURPOSE	VALUES
Why we exist Veritas Lab exists to give analysts the tools to verify the authenticity of media in a world where synthetic content is indistinguishable from real. We exist to make truth legible.	What we believe Transparency over opacity. Every AI result is explained, never just asserted. Evidence integrity is non-negotiable. Users are analysts, not passive recipients of verdicts.
VOICE	TONE
How we sound, always Veritas Lab speaks like a calm, precise expert. Direct. Unambiguous. We do not hedge with vague language. Every label, error message, and button is written as if a senior forensic analyst drafted it.	How we sound, situationally Voice is constant; tone adjusts. A confirmed deepfake result is sober and factual. A successful upload is reassuring. An authentication error is honest and actionable. Same person, different room.

2.1 Voice in UI Copy: Examples

Context	Wrong (vague / tech-speak)	Right (Voice-aligned)
Error message	ERR_VALIDATION_FAILED	The email address format is invalid.
Deepfake result	Confidence: 0.94	Manipulation detected. Confidence: 94%.
Upload success	File uploaded successfully.	Evidence saved. Analysis will begin shortly.
Confirm delete	Are you sure?	This will permanently remove the case and all linked evidence. This cannot be undone.

2.2 Design Principles

Four high-level principles govern every visual and interaction decision in Veritas Lab. They are not aspirational, each one is enforced by a concrete mechanism in this guide.

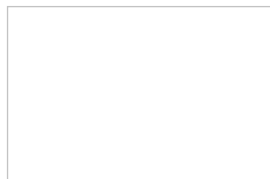
Principle	Definition	How Veritas Lab enforces it
Consistency	The product looks and behaves as if one author built it.	The design token system ensures one change propagates everywhere. The shared component library enforces uniform behaviour across all screens. See Section 4.
Simplicity	Every element earns its place. Nothing is added for decoration alone.	The 60/30/10 colour rule limits palette complexity. A maximum of two font weights per screen is enforced. Glassmorphic effects are deferred until core screens are stable. See Sections 3 and 5.
Responsiveness	The interface works correctly across the target range of screen sizes.	A 12-column grid with defined breakpoints from sm (640px) to 2xl (1536px) governs all layout decisions. The primary target is the analyst workstation (lg, 1024px+). See Section 7.2.
Accessibility	Every user, regardless of ability, can complete core analyst workflows.	WCAG 2.2 Level AA compliance is a hard requirement. The POUR framework (Perceivable, Operable, Understandable, Robust) organises all accessibility requirements. Colour contrast ratios, keyboard navigation, and screen reader compatibility are all specified. See Section 10.

3. Colour Tokens

Colours are defined by **role**, **not by hue**. The token name describes the job the colour performs. When the palette evolves, the job stays the same and only the hex value changes, every button, link, and focus ring updates automatically. **color.action** beats **color.green**.

3.1 Core Palette: 60 / 30 / 10 Rule

One dominant colour carries the surface (60%). One supporting colour structures content (30%). One accent does the work: actions, focus, identity (10%).



color.surface
#ffffff

60% Dominant



color.ink
#231f20

30% Supporting



color.action
#3dbf79

10% Accent



color.muted
#C3C3C3

Structural

*Note: Brand Green (#3dbf79) is close enough to white in terms of brightness that it **must not** be used as body text colour on white. Use it as a background (with white text) or for large bold labels only. If a brand colour fails contrast, it is not a brand colour for text.*

3.2 Colour Usage Rules

Token	Hex	Usage Rule
<code>color.action</code>	<code>#3dbf79</code>	Sidebar background, confirmation buttons, login/signup backgrounds, active nav indicators, focus rings.
<code>color.ink</code>	<code>#231f20</code>	Primary headings, body text on white. Logo on white backgrounds. Most text across the application.
<code>color.surface</code>	<code>#ffffff</code>	Page backgrounds, text on green backgrounds. Logo on green. Non-confirmation button fills (sometimes with green stroke).
<code>color.muted</code>	<code>#C3C3C3</code>	Subheadings, placeholder text, secondary labels, dividers, disabled borders.

3.3 Semantic Colours

Semantic colours communicate system state. They are never decorative. Colour is never the sole differentiator, every semantic state also has a text label.



color.error
#e53e3e



color.warning
#d97706



color.info
#2b6cb0



color.success
#2a9a5e

The deepfake detection confidence system maps directly to semantic colours: color.error for confirmed manipulation, color.warning for inconclusive, color.action (green) for authentic. This mapping is fixed and must not be altered.

4. Design Tokens

A design token is a name for a decision. Once named, it can be referenced by Figma, by CSS, by any platform, every surface speaks the same language. Tokens are the contract between design and code. Update a token once and every button, link, spacing unit, and focus ring that references it updates everywhere, with no manual search-and-replace across every component.

4.1 Token Inventory

The token set covers four categories. The canonical token file and its mapping to CSS variables live in the repository and are not duplicated here. This table defines the decisions, the implementation details follow in code.

Category	Tokens Defined	What they govern
Colour	<code>color.action</code> , <code>color.ink</code> , <code>color.surface</code> , <code>color.muted</code> , <code>color.error</code> , <code>color.warning</code> , <code>color.info</code>	Every background, text, border, and state colour in the product.
Spacing	<code>space-1 (4px)</code> through <code>space-16 (64px)</code>	All padding, margin, and gap values. Only multiples of the 4px base unit.
Radius	<code>radius.sm (4)</code> , <code>radius.md (6)</code> , <code>radius.lg (12)</code> , <code>radius.full</code>	Border radius for buttons, inputs, cards, badges, and modals.
Motion	<code>motion.fast (150ms)</code> , <code>motion.normal (250ms)</code> , <code>motion.slow (400ms)</code>	All transition and animation durations. Easing: cubic-bezier(0.2, 0, 0, 1).
Typography	<code>font.sans (Inter)</code> , <code>font.mono (JetBrains Mono)</code> , <code>weights 400/500/600/700</code>	Font family, weight ladder, and size scale across all surfaces.

4.2 Why Tokens Matter

- **One change, everywhere:** Update `color.action` from `#3dbf79` to any new brand green, every button, sidebar, and focus ring follows.
- **Theming for free:** Light/dark mode, client white-label variants, and future brand updates become token swaps, not parallel codebases. See Section 11 for dark mode tokens.
- **Platform agnostic:** The same token definitions can target CSS variables, iOS Swift, Android XML, or Flutter via Style Dictionary.
- **Design-developer alignment:** Figma variables reference the same token names as code. A designer changes a token; the engineer pulls it, no translation layer.

5. Typography

A typeface speaks before a single word is read. It carries era, trust, class, and information density. The primary typeface for Veritas Lab is **Inter**, a humanist sans-serif optimised for screen legibility. Inter is included via **next/font/google** at zero bundle cost. For monospaced content (file hashes, model version strings, case IDs, code) the typeface is **JetBrains Mono**. Inter reads as precise and trustworthy, which aligns directly with the brand voice.

5.1 Type Scale (Modular, 1.250 ratio)

A type scale is not a list of fonts. It is a **relationship** between sizes, weights, and line-heights, a hierarchy your eye can navigate without thinking. The scale uses a 1.250 modular ratio. Marketing pages, dashboards, and analyst views all share the same scale. Line-height is part of the token, size without line-height is a half-decision.

Token	Font / Weight	Size	Line Height	Usage
display	Inter Bold 700	36px / 2.25rem	44px	Page titles, cover headers
heading-1	Inter Bold 700	28px / 1.75rem	36px	Section headings
heading-2	Inter SemiBold 600	22px / 1.375rem	30px	Subsection headings
heading-3	Inter SemiBold 600	18px / 1.125rem	26px	Card and panel titles
body-lg	Inter Regular 400	16px / 1rem	26px	Primary reading content
body	Inter Regular 400	14px / 0.875rem	22px	Default interface text
caption	Inter Regular 400	12px / 0.75rem	18px	Labels, timestamps, metadata
overline	Inter Medium 500	11px / 0.6875rem	16px	Category labels, ALLCAPS badges
code	JetBrains Mono 400	13px / 0.8125rem	20px	Hashes, model refs, file paths, case IDs

5.2 Typography Rules

- Weights are a ladder, not a buffet. Use only three weights: Regular (400), SemiBold (600), Bold (700). Never invent intermediate steps.
- Never use more than two font weights on a single screen.
- Headings (display–heading-3) use **color.ink (#231f20)** on white surfaces.
- On **color.action** (green) surfaces, all text is **color.surface (white)**.
- **color.muted (#C3C3C3)** is reserved for subheadings, placeholders, and secondary labels only. Never use it for body text.
- Monospace stack is mandatory for machine-generated data: file hashes, model version strings, case reference numbers, timestamps.

- Reading width: body text columns should be 50–75 characters wide. Wider columns reduce comprehension. Use max-w-prose in Tailwind.
- Do not use italic for UI labels. Reserve italic for legal disclaimers and inline citations only.
- Minimum readable text size is 12px (0.75rem) for WCAG AA compliance.

6. Logo and Iconography

The Naked Insurance logo is not used in Veritas Lab. DeltaTech has established a dedicated wordmark derived from **Inter Bold**. The name VERITAS (Latin: truth) underpins the brand identity and aligns directly with the system's purpose: making truth legible.

6.1 Primary Wordmark: Three Approved Versions



6.2 Logo Usage Rules

- Minimum clear space: equal to the cap-height of the letter V on all four sides. Never crowd the wordmark.
- Minimum digital size: 80px wide. Minimum print size: 25mm wide.
- Do not stretch, rotate, skew, recolour, or add effects outside the three approved versions.
- Do not place the wordmark on a photographic or busy background without a solid backing panel.
- The green underline accent (color.action) is a mandatory part of the lockup. It must not be removed or recoloured.
- The VERITAS wordmark is always Inter Bold. LAB is always Inter Regular, one weight step lighter.
- Logo on white: VERITAS in color.ink, accent and LAB in color.action.
- Logo on green: VERITAS, LAB, and accent all in color.surface (white).
- Logo on black: VERITAS and LAB in color.surface (white), accent in color.action.

6.3 Icon Library: Lucide React

All icons are sourced from **Lucide React** (lucide.dev), which ships natively with Next.js. Icons are used at consistent sizes: 16px for inline/label icons, 20px for action button icons, 24px for navigation items. Custom icons (such as the confidence meter or provenance chain indicator) must match Lucide's 1.5px stroke weight and visual weight to maintain coherence.

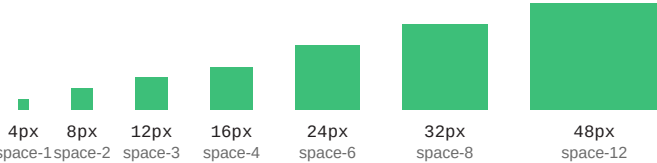
- Purely decorative icons: **aria-hidden='true'**.
- Meaningful icons: must have an **aria-label** or be paired with a visible text label.
- Never substitute an icon for a status label alone. Always accompany with text (colour is not the sole differentiator).

7. Spacing, Layout, and Motion

Spacing, layout grid, and motion are the systems most easily overlooked in a style guide, and the omission shows immediately in the product. The eye reads consistent spacing as 'designed'; arbitrary spacing as 'rushed'.

7.1 Spacing System

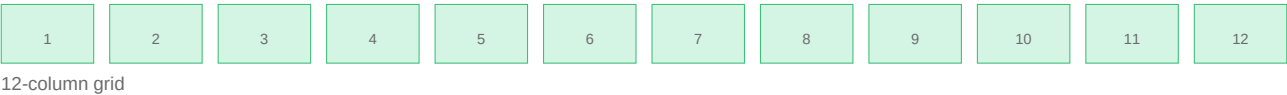
The base unit is **4px**. All spacing values are multiples of 4. Never use an arbitrary pixel value that is not on the scale. In Tailwind, the default spacing scale is already 4px-based, use only the tokens below.



Token	Value	Tailwind Class	Typical Usage
space-1	4px	p-1 / gap-1	Icon padding, tight inline gaps
space-2	8px	p-2 / gap-2	Badge padding, form field internal gaps
space-3	12px	p-3 / gap-3	Button padding (vertical)
space-4	16px	p-4 / gap-4	Card padding, input padding
space-6	24px	p-6 / gap-6	Section internal spacing
space-8	32px	p-8 / gap-8	Between major sections
space-12	48px	p-12 / gap-12	Page-level vertical rhythm
space-16	64px	p-16 / gap-16	Hero/cover spacing

7.2 Layout Grid

The layout system uses a **12-column grid**. Columns, gutters, and breakpoints are defined explicitly so that content reflows across viewports without redesign.



Breakpoint	Width	Columns	Gutter	Usage
sm	640px	4 cols	16px	Tablet portrait (login, report-sharing screens)
md	768px	8 cols	20px	Tablet landscape (lightweight views)
lg	1024px	12 cols	24px	Desktop, primary analyst workstation target
xl	1280px	12 cols	24px	Wide desktop

2xl	1536px	12 cols	32px	Ultrawide, max-w-screen-xl container applied
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7.3 Motion Tokens

Time is a design dimension. Motion communicates state changes the user would otherwise miss. Durations and easings are design tokens, not hardcoded values in component files.

Token	Duration	Easing	Usage
motion.fast	150ms	cubic-bezier(0.2, 0, 0, 1)	Hover states, focus rings, badge appearance
motion.normal	250ms	cubic-bezier(0.2, 0, 0, 1)	Modal open/close, panel expand/collapse, page transitions
motion.slow	400ms	cubic-bezier(0.2, 0, 0, 1)	Full-page transitions, onboarding animations, result reveals

- Never animate at motion.slow for interactive feedback, the user will perceive the UI as slow.
- Respect prefers-reduced-motion: all animations must be disabled or reduced when the OS accessibility setting is active.
- Do not add motion to the first iteration of a component. Ship it static, then add motion when the behaviour is confirmed.

8. Component Model (Atomic Design)

All Veritas Lab components are organised using Brad Frost's Atomic Design hierarchy. The principle is: **build small, well-tested pieces, then compose**. This is the same principle as good software engineering applied to the UI layer. Components at each level have a single, clear responsibility.

Level	Definition	Veritas Lab Examples
01 ATOMS	Indivisible primitives. Cannot be broken down further.	Button, Input, Icon, Label, Badge, Token, Spinner
02 MOLECULES	Small functional units. Two or more atoms working together.	SearchField, FormRow, AvatarWithName, ConfidenceBadge, FileUploadRow
03 ORGANISMS	Composed sections with real functionality.	CaseCard, EvidencePanel, AnalysisResultCard, NavigationBar, UploadModal
04 TEMPLATES	Page-level structure with slots for content.	DashboardLayout, CaseDetailLayout, AuthLayout
05 PAGES	Real content and real data filling a template.	Dashboard, CaseDetail, Login, AnalysisView, Reports

8.1 Component Contract

A component is a contract, not just a visual. Every atom and molecule must have documented: its visual states, its props API, its accessibility requirements, and explicit do/don't usage examples. The button atom's contract is the reference model for all components (see Section 9).

- Components at lower levels (atoms, molecules) must be visually self-contained, they carry no knowledge of the page or feature they appear in.
- Never duplicate a component. If two screens need a similar pattern, extract it to the appropriate Atomic level.
- The point is not the labels. The point is that each level has a single, clear visual responsibility. The same principle governs good software engineering.

9. UI Component Styling

All UI components are built with Tailwind CSS using the team's own component library. The following specifications define the required visual states and usage rules for each component category. Every component must implement all documented states before it is considered complete.

9.1 Button: All 8 States

A button is a contract, not a sticker. All eight states must be implemented and visually distinct. A button that only has a default state is an incomplete component.

Action

Action

Action

Action

Row 1: Interactive states

default

hover

active

focused

Action

Action

Delete

Action

Row 2: Variant states

disabled

loading

danger

ghost

State	Fill	Border	Text	Notes
default	color.action	none	color.surface	Primary confirmation state
hover	color.action-dark	none	color.surface	+brightness, cursor: pointer
active	#259058 (pressed)	none	color.surface	Pressed/mousedown state
focused	color.action	color.action-dark 2px	color.surface	Visible ring, keyboard navigation
disabled	color.action-light	color.muted 0.5px	color.muted	No-op; low contrast signals unavailability
loading	color.action	none	color.surface	Spinner visible; aria-busy='true'
danger	color.error	none	color.surface	Destructive actions only; always confirm
ghost	transparent	color.action 1.5px	color.action	Cancel, back, secondary non-destructive

- Button API: `<Button variant intent size leadingIcon disabled loading onClick />`
- Minimum height: 36px. Minimum horizontal padding: 12px. Border radius: radius.md (6px).
- Do not stack two primary (green) buttons on the same screen.
- Do not use the disabled state to replace a permission error, explain why the action is unavailable.
- The loading state must include `aria-busy='true'` and disable click events to prevent double-submission.

9.2 Form Inputs: 4 States



- **Default:** White background, 1px color.muted border, placeholder text at 60% opacity.
- **Focus:** White background, 2px color.action border. The green border is the sole focus signal, no box shadow.
- **Error:** White background, 2px color.error border, plain-language error message directly below the field in color.error at 12px.
- **Success (post-validation):** White background, 1px color.action border.
- Inline validation feedback must appear within **200ms** of user interaction (per client design requirement).
- Error messages must be human-readable: 'Email is required.' not 'VALIDATION_ERROR_EMPTY'.
- Placeholder text is not a label. Every input must have an associated visible label or aria-label.

9.3 Navigation Bar

- Full-width top bar with **color.action (#3dbf79)** background, white text and icons.
- VERITAS LAB wordmark left-aligned. Navigation items right of the wordmark.
- Active item: White 2px underline. Not a colour change, colour alone must not be the sole indicator.
- User avatar / profile indicator at far-right.
- Sidebar (case navigation): also color.action background with white labels, consistent with top bar.

9.4 Status and Confidence Badges



Badge	Background	Text	aria-label example
DEEPFAKE DETECTED	color.error #e53e3e	white	Analysis result: Deepfake Detected, 94% confidence
INCONCLUSIVE	color.warning #d97706	white	Analysis result: Inconclusive, confidence 42-58%
AUTHENTIC	color.action #3dbf79	white	Analysis result: Authentic, 97% confidence
PROCESSING	color.info #2b6cb0	white	Analysis status: Processing, estimated 2 minutes remaining

- Badge text: always overline token (uppercase, Inter Medium, 11px).
- Colour is never the sole differentiator. Each badge has a distinct text label.

9.5 Case / Evidence Cards

- White background, 1px color.muted border, drop shadow: 0 2px 8px rgba(35,31,32,0.08).
- 6px color.action top accent bar visually anchors the card and distinguishes it from a plain panel.
- Card title: heading-3 style (Inter SemiBold 18px, color.ink). Metadata: caption style (12px, color.muted-dark).
- Status badge in bottom-left of card footer row.
- Maximum card width: 480px. Grid: 3 columns on desktop (lg), 1 column on mobile (sm).

9.6 Modals and Dialogs

- White card on semi-transparent color.ink overlay (rgba(35,31,32,0.6)).
- Modal header: color.ink background, white title in heading-3 style.
- Destructive confirmation: Danger (red) button paired with Ghost cancel button. Both visible.
- Overlay click should not dismiss a destructive confirmation dialog. The user must make an explicit choice: confirm or cancel. This preserves the intent of the interaction.
- Maximum width: 560px. Maximum height: 80vh with internal scroll.
- Focus is trapped inside the modal while open. Closing restores focus to the trigger element.

10. Accessibility (POUR)

Accessibility is a **system property**. It cannot be bolted on at the end. It must be baked into every token, every component, and every guideline from the start. Veritas Lab complies with **WCAG 2.2 Level AA**. The POUR framework (Perceivable, Operable, Understandable, Robust) organises all requirements.

PERCEIVABLE	OPERABLE
Can users sense the content? Sufficient colour contrast (WCAG 2.2 AA: 4.5:1 body text, 3:1 large text and UI components). Meaningful images have alt text. Colour is never the sole conveyor of state.	Can users drive the interface? Every interactive element is reachable by keyboard. Visible focus rings at all times, the focused element must be unambiguous. No keyboard traps.
UNDERSTANDABLE	ROBUST
Can users predict behaviour? Consistent navigation. Plain-language errors that explain what to do. Form fields have proper labels, placeholder text is not a label.	Will it work everywhere? Test with a real screen reader (NVDA or VoiceOver). Semantic HTML elements. ARIA only where native semantics are insufficient.

10.1 Colour Contrast Ratios (PERCEIVABLE)

Foreground	Background	Ratio	Usage	Result
color.ink #231f20	color.surface #fff	17.5:1	Body text, headings	AAA
color.surface #fff	color.ink #231f20	17.5:1	White text on dark bg	AAA
color.surface #fff	color.error #e53e3e	4.6:1	Badge text on error	AA
color.surface #fff	color.warning #d97706	3.1:1	Badge text on warning	AA Large
color.surface #fff	color.action #3dbf79	2.8:1	Large bold text ONLY	AA Large
color.ink #231f20	color.muted #C3C3C3	6.1:1	Text on grey surface	AA
color.muted #C3C3C3	color.surface #fff	1.6:1	Placeholder (decorative)	N/A

color.action (#3dbf79) achieves only 2.8:1 on white. It passes AA for large text (18px+ regular or 14px+ bold) only. Never use it as body text on a white background.

10.2 Keyboard Navigation (OPERABLE)

- All interactive elements reachable via Tab in logical DOM order.
- Focus indicator: color.action ring (--ring CSS variable). Never suppress with outline: none without a custom equivalent.
- Modal dialogs trap focus while open. Closing returns focus to the trigger element.
- Sidebar navigation supports arrow-key traversal between items.
- Minimum click/touch target: 44x44px on all interactive elements.

10.3 Plain Language and Labels (UNDERSTANDABLE)

- Inline validation must appear within 200ms and be placed adjacent to the affected field, not as a top-of-page toast.
- Error messages explain the rule that failed: 'Email is required.' not 'FIELD_EMPTY'.
- All inputs have an associated <label> or aria-label. Placeholder text is not a label.
- Destructive action confirmation dialogs state the specific consequence: what will be deleted, that it cannot be undone.

10.4 Screen Reader Compatibility (ROBUST)

- Decorative icons: aria-hidden='true'. Meaningful icons: aria-label describing the action.
- Status badges: aria-label includes full result, confidence, and model version where applicable.
- Dynamic content (new case loaded, job progress, validation errors): aria-live regions notify screen reader users without a page reload.
- All core analyst workflows (upload, review, annotate, export) completable by keyboard alone.
- Test with NVDA (Windows) or VoiceOver (macOS) before marking any feature complete.

11. Dark Mode

Veritas Lab is a forensic analyst workstation. Analysts work long, focused sessions, often in low-light environments, reviewing evidence that demands sustained concentration. Dark mode is not a cosmetic option for this product. It is an expected feature and should be treated as a first-class surface from the start.

Because the colour system uses semantic tokens (color.surface, color.ink, etc.) rather than hardcoded hex values, dark mode is a token swap, not a parallel codebase. Switching themes means swapping the token values; every component that references the tokens updates automatically.

11.1 Dark Mode Token Swaps

The following table defines what each token resolves to in dark mode. The action colour (brand green) and all semantic colours remain unchanged across themes, only the surface and text tokens swap.

Token	Light Mode	Dark Mode	Notes
color.surface	#ffffff	#1a1a1a	Page background
color.surface-2	#f7f7f7	#242424	Cards, panels, alternate rows
color.surface-3	#efefef	#2e2e2e	Hover states, nested surfaces
color.ink	#231f20	#f5f5f5	Primary text and headings
color.muted	#C3C3C3	#888888	Secondary labels, placeholders
color.action	#3dbf79	#3dbf79	Unchanged, green works on dark surfaces
color.error	#e53e3e	#e53e3e	Unchanged, semantic colours are theme-stable

11.2 Dark Mode Colour Swatches



color.surface
#1a1a1a

Page background



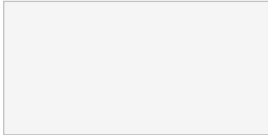
color.surface-2
#242424

Cards / panels



color.surface-3
#2e2e2e

Hover states



color.ink
#f5f5f5

Primary text

11.3 Dark Mode Design Rules

- The brand green (#3dbf79) achieves 4.6:1 against #1a1a1a, it passes WCAG AA for normal text on dark surfaces. It remains the primary action and focus colour in dark mode.
- Do not add extra visual weight (heavier borders, additional shadows) to dark surfaces. The contrast difference between surface layers is the structural signal.
- Evidence content (uploaded media, AI result panels) should maintain the same semantic colour coding across both themes. A deepfake badge is always color.error regardless of theme.
- Theme preference must be persisted per user account, not just per session. An analyst should not have to reset their theme after logging back in.
- Provide a theme toggle in the user profile menu and in the application header. Never auto-switch based on OS setting without giving the user explicit control.
- Test every screen in both themes before marking a feature complete. A component that only looks correct in one theme is a half-finished component.